

COMMUNICATION & RESPONSE AUDIT

The Window Valet

Every incoming reply should be seen, owned, and answered fast, without anyone having to get lucky

Prepared for Josh LeClair by John Carlo Caintic · Marketing Strategy & Automation · August 25, 2026

Renee and Erica's instinct was right: replies aren't being ignored, they're getting buried by a setup that was never built to surface them. The fix isn't a policy reminding people to check more often, it's closing the two real gaps that make a reply easy to miss in the first place, then giving the team a daily rhythm that makes missing one nearly impossible.

Where a Reply Actually Gets Lost

Customer Replies Working	Lands in Conversations Working	Assigned to Owner Working	Noticed in Time Depends on luck	Escalated if Missed Didn't exist	Logged for Review No record
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A reply is captured and routed correctly from the start. It falls apart at the point where noticing it depends entirely on someone happening to look, with nothing behind that to catch a miss or prove what happened.

700 Unread conversations sitting in the shared Team Inbox	28 Of those actually assigned to Renee, once filtered	0 Workflows that currently react when a lead replies
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The 700-deep shared queue is the real problem, not Renee or Erica's attention. And "Unread" itself can't be trusted as a safety net: opening a conversation clears it from that list whether or not anyone actually replied, so there's currently no way to tell a handled conversation from a dismissed one.

The Fix

Change	What it does
Harden notifications	Confirm Renee and Erica have the GHL mobile app with notifications allowed, and add SMS as a backup specifically on new messages where they're the owner, so a reply reaches their phone even if the app's push access ever quietly fails.
Give Renee her own queue	A saved view filtered to Unread + Assigned to Renee turns the unusable 700-deep pile into the 28 that are actually hers, a queue she can realistically clear every day.
New workflow: Customer Reply Response & Escalation	The moment a lead replies, a 15-minute grace period starts. If nobody's answered by then, it creates a task and pings the owner directly. Still unanswered 15 minutes later, it escalates to a backup. The instant staff actually reply, the workflow exits, so nothing fires on a conversation that's already being handled.

Daily Operating Procedure

MORNING

- Open your filtered Unread view, not the shared Team Inbox, and clear anything from overnight, oldest first
- Check your Tasks list for any "Reply needed" items, that's the real backlog, not just what looks unread
- Glance at today's appointments for any self-booked ones still needing confirmation

THROUGHOUT THE DAY

- Reply promptly, a reply is what clears the automatic escalation, marking something read does not
- Away from your desk for more than a few minutes? Check your phone rather than waiting to get back
- Treat a "Reply needed" task as the real signal, the Conversations badge alone isn't reliable

BEFORE LEAVING

- Recheck your filtered Unread view and Task list, nothing should carry into tomorrow unacknowledged
- Genuinely waiting on the customer? Leave a quick note so it isn't mistaken for something dropped
- Flag anything you can't close out to whoever's covering next

How management audits this

Don't audit by the Unread badge, it clears with or without a reply. Audit by the new workflow's tasks instead, that's the objective record of what actually happened.

A person issue

Tasks are being created on time, but the same person's tasks run overdue. That's a coaching conversation.

A system issue

Leads are still coming in, but few or no tasks are being created at all. That's a configuration problem, bring it back to us.

Next step: confirm the mobile app and SMS backup this week, get Renee's saved view set up now, and once you approve the new workflow, no reply sits silently again, whether it's missed or just slow gets an honest answer either way.

Part of the ongoing GHL stabilization work under the Week 1/2 roadmap.